

is to explain back to the company what it already knows is happening to itself. Excessive flattery, or criticism, or unusual conclusions might sour an analyst's relationship with a company that he or she must continue to analyze. Although Gillette is famous for its even-handed treatment of all analysts, Mr. Glass didn't doubt that at some companies, the skeptical analyst, like the skeptical newspaper reporter, might fall out of grace with official sources.

All this was so interesting that we got to dessert before I remembered to ask Mr. Glass about the stock. If analysts tell their big clients what Mr. Glass tells them, then I was sitting with the horse's mouth. Trying not to be obvious, I leaned over a coffee cup and whispered: "Maybe you can't say anything because of your position, but do you think I made a good deal at 79 $\frac{1}{4}$?" "I don't know," Mr. Glass said rather loudly. "I sold all my shares a couple of months ago at \$60."

Back at Prudential-Bache in New York, I revisited Ms. Hall, informed her of all the above, and spent an afternoon plus an evening hanging around her office and following her around the building. She took me upstairs to a fancy buffet party where new stockbrokers were initiated to the rigors of New York. There was plenty of caviar and little pâté sandwiches, and as much liquor as we could drink. After that, she let me sit in her cubicle while she made telephone calls.

Like Ms. Longley, Ms. Hall seemed to do nothing but work. In the morning, she prepared her presentation on the squawk box, plus she helped plan the upcoming "road show" for Munsingwear. "Road shows" are frequent whirlwind trips around the country, where analysts meet local brokers and drum up support for their favorite shares.

Even in the corridor on her way to and from the elevator or the bathroom, Ms. Hall was on the job. She accidentally bumped into a mutual-fund manager, and I saw her immediately seize the opportunity to tell him the Gillette story, and to give him a sample of the new brown swivel razor. She was always on the lookout for potential buyers for her favorite stocks.

To say that the primary duty of an analyst is to analyze a stock couldn't be further from the truth. After spending a few hours with Ms. Hall, I realized that an analyst is first and foremost a